



Drawing tool for the best from the best

Illustrator, like Photoshop, has a lot of competitors who are mostly competing on price, but for those who value efficiency over money, Illustrator is still a very strong and versatile tool that Adobe is continually working to enhance.

We particularly enjoy the new 3D tools, sleek vector editing, and cloud teamwork features in the most recent release. A Freeform Gradients tool that makes creating rich gradients a breeze, a Global Editing feature that enables you make changes to all instances of a comparable object at once, and a smart cropping tool that automatically offers crops based on AI are among the most recent improvements.

The concerns that apply to Photoshop also apply to Illustrator in a broader sense. On the plus side, its widespread availability makes it a good tool for learning for your career, and its integration with the Creative Cloud can make your workflow more efficient. On the down side, its decades-old codebase and UI are growing bloated, and there's always the monthly subscription.

Affinity Designer

Since its introduction for Windows in 2016, Affinity Designer has provided a mature alternative to Illustrator, with features such as a complete vector and pixel editing toolkit, 10 million percent zoom, non-destructive effects and adjustment layers, and more.

It offers good value for money and can easily handle a big load. While some features in Illustrator, such as distortion and warp effects, are not